

Eddy Shah

No. 162

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

Selim “Eddy” Shah, born in Cambridge in 1944, revolutionised the British newspaper industry. After early work in theatre and television, he started his own local newspaper, embracing modern computer technology instead of traditional hot-metal printing. In 1983, he famously challenged the print unions, refusing to reinstate striking staff, sparking mass picketing and court battles.

In 1986, Shah launched Today, the first national newspaper with colour and produced without union interference, pioneering electronic production. Although Today was not commercially successful, it forced all UK national newspapers to modernise, leading to the collapse of Fleet Street’s traditional print unions and transforming the industry. His courage and innovation earned him recognition as a central figure in Britain’s media revolution.